Whose Land, Whose Water? · student sheet

Première générale, LVA B1+, LVB B1 | Eight lessons of 55 minutes, timed for 52 minutes

Official page: https://itineraires-destinations.fr/whose-land-whose-water/

Name: _____ Class or group: _____

Guiding question. When a government makes promises to Indigenous peoples, who decides what happens to the land and the water, and how can citizens check whether those promises are kept?

Use the names that peoples give themselves. Every figure needs its source and, if it changes, its date. Look at both sides: what was done, and what was not done.

Lesson 1. Look Before You Judge

Useful words: kinship · living relative · sacred · unceded land · stewardship · resource

Look at the two paintings on the official lesson 1 page: Jim Logan, *No One to Play with but his Dog*, and Norval Morrisseau, *Loon and Fish*, reproduced with permission.

Written record:

Homework: 60 to 80 words, with at least three of the words above, and careful language (may, might, is often read as).

Lesson 2. 1969: the White Paper and the Red Paper

Useful words: to repeal · to abolish · to withdraw · Citizens Plus · to wipe out a right

The government was going to… The chiefs said that it would…

Written record:

Homework: 80 words, with *was going to* and *said that it would*.

Lesson 3. Rivers into Reservoirs

Useful words: dam · reservoir · to relocate · mercury · trapline

Fort George → Chisasibi. The river became twice as fast. Daisy House: “We’re not anti-development, we’re anti-destruction.”

Written record:

Homework: 100-word testimony with *used to*, *would* and one past perfect.

Lesson 4. Dams Today

Muskrat Falls (Labrador): fear of methylmercury in Lake Melville. Billy Gauthier, hunger strike, 2016.

Site C (Peace River): fully online in August 2025; cost nearly double the first price; Treaty 8 nations, such as West Moberly, objected.

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Written record (one fact with its source for each dam):

Homework: 120 words, is hydroelectricity “clean” energy for everyone? One causative, one comparison.

Lesson 5. Pipelines on Unceded Land

Useful words: consent · consultation · band council · hereditary chief · a stake · an injunction

Coastal GasLink: most Wet’suwet’en hereditary chiefs said no; most band councils said yes. Trans Mountain: court quashed the first approval in 2018; expansion started 1 May 2024. September 2026 offer of a 15 per cent stake: still in negotiation on 4 November 2026.

Written record:

Homework: a two-column table, for and against one pipeline, with a source for each argument.

Lesson 6. Promises Kept, Promises Broken

Official figures, Indigenous Services Canada, as of 21 October 2026 (check them before you use them: they change).

158 long-term drinking-water advisories lifted since November 2015. 39 still in effect, in 37 communities. Deadline promised: March 2021.

Useful words: pledge · deadline · to lift an advisory · to fall short of · failed to · should have

Written record (verdict, with two facts and their source):

Homework: language page, exercises 3 and 4; finish the fact-check table.

Lesson 7. The Grizzlies

Set in Kugluktuk, Nunavut. A lacrosse team becomes a family. Useful words: resilience · to give up · to stand up for · self-determination.

You do not need to watch the whole film in class. The lesson page has a synopsis and advised extracts for an optional interview (preview: difficult topics in some parts).

Written record:

Homework: finish a 150-word review; choose a lesson-8 dossier with your group.

Lesson 8. Final Task: A Citizens’ Hearing and an Open Letter

Dossier A: White Paper and Red Paper. B: dams. C: pipelines. D: drinking water and the Calls to Action.

Four parts: 1. The promise (reported speech). 2. What was done (passive, source). 3. What was not done (failed to, should have, source). 4. Recommendation (ought to, have to).

My four-part plan:

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Open letter (200 to 250 words) to a Member of Parliament. Opening:

Homework: finish the letter; a short self-assessment; one sentence: what I will remember from this unit.

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